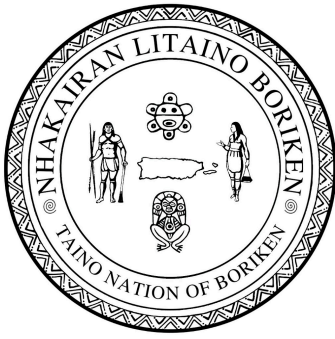




Taíno Nation of the Boriken

Report on Ancestral Yucayeques of Borikén

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Date: 5/1/2025

Introduction

This report presents a summary of archaeological and ethnohistorical research regarding the ancestral Yucayekes (villages) and their Cacicazgos (chiefdoms) of Borikén (Puerto Rico). The goal is to affirm and clarify the historical and geographical presence of Indigenous Taíno settlements as corroborated through documentary evidence, oral traditions, and archaeological data. The findings are provided in collaboration with ongoing Indigenous community efforts to preserve and revitalize Borikua Taíno heritage and sovereignty.

Yucayeques De Puerto Rico



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Summary of Confirmed and Investigated Sites

Below is an itemized list of historically recognized Indigenous towns and the names of their known or attributed Caciques, followed by field notes or concerns raised during research:

Sites Marked Confirmed in the Report (with corresponding reasoning):

1. **AMON/A (Mona/Amonilla)** – Confirmed location
2. **AYMACO (Aguadilla)** – Aymanio more likely than Amamón. Confirmed presence.

3. **ABACOA (Quebradillas–Arecibo)** – Confirmed
4. **CIBUCO / SEBUCO (Vega Baja)** – Confirmed
5. **TOA (Vega Alta)** – Confirmed
6. **BAYAMÓN / TOA ALTA / TOA BAJA (Majagua)** – Confirmed
7. **HAIMANIO / HAMANIO (Loíza)** – Most plausible that Yuisa was relative of Aymanio
8. **CAYNAIBON / CANAIBON (Canóvanas/Río Grande)** – Confirmed
9. **DAGUAO / DACUAO (Luquillo/Fajardo/Naguabo)** – Daguaao historically recorded
10. **BIEKE (Vieques, Culebra)** – Confirmed
11. **MACAO (Humacao)** – Confirmed
12. **GUAYANEY (Patillas/Maunabo)** – Confirmed
13. **GUAYAMA** – Confirmed
14. **TURABO (Caguas)** – Confirmed
15. **ATIBONICO / JATOBONICO (Orocovis/Barranquitas/Coamo)** – Confirmed
16. **OTOAO / OTAO (San Sebastián/Lares/Utuado)** – Confirmed
17. **GUAINIA / GUANIA (Cabo Rojo–Ponce)** – Confirmed
18. **YAGUECA / YAGUECAX (Mayagüez)** – Confirmed

Subtotal: 18 confirmed yucayekes

Sites Marked as Unconfirmed / Need Clarification:

19. **GUAYNABO** – Mabo not confirmed; earliest records cite Guamaní.
20. **CULEBRA** – Indigenous name undocumented. Suggested to merge with Bieke.
21. **GUAJATACA** – No confirmed yucayeke; possibly a misreading of Aymaco.
22. **GUAMA** – Appears in maps, yucayeke unidentified.
23. **ABEYNO** – Possibly Abey of Otoa; region name unconfirmed.
24. **COABEY (Jayuya)** – No confirmed yucayeke, but toponym persists.
25. **CAYECO** – Appears on one map, no documentation.

Subtotal: 7 sites needing further research

Key Considerations & Recommendations

1. Historical Discrepancies

Names of caciques and yucayekes sometimes overlap or shift depending on colonial interpretations and Spanish transcription errors. Caution must be taken in aligning modern place names with Indigenous settlements.

2. Oral Histories as Evidence

In cases like Guajataca, oral history may preserve valid connections where documentation fails. Such traditions deserve scholarly and community attention.

3. Unconfirmed but Notable Sites

Some sites (e.g., Coabey, Guama) deserve further investigation. Absence from colonial records does not imply nonexistence—particularly where archaeology or Indigenous oral record affirms continuity.

4. Regional Consolidation

Some modern municipalities may encompass multiple yucayekes (e.g., Bayamón region includes Majagua and possibly others). Mapping should reflect this complexity.

5. Place Name Preservation

Modern usage of names like “Coabey” in Jayuya suggests Indigenous persistence in toponymy. Recognition of these names helps strengthen cultural continuity.

Conclusion

This report affirms 18 core yucayekes with historical confirmation and recognizes at least 7 additional sites requiring further documentation or oral tradition validation. These findings are offered in service to the living descendants and tribal villages of Borikén who continue to steward these lands and their histories.

Respectfully submitted,

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